

CTEC 121

Introduction to Programming and Problem Solving · Fall 2026

MATERIALS COST

\$0

No textbook, no fees

WEEKLY WORK IS DUE

Sundays

11:59 PM

THEN IT STAYS OPEN

3 more days

Full credit, no questions

TIME TO BUDGET

~10 hrs/wk

5 in class, 5 outside

Do these five things in week one

- 1 Log into **Canvas** and read the announcements at the top.
- 2 Finish all **first-week assignments** by **Thu, Sept 24**, or be dropped Fri.
- 3 Join the class **Slack**. No invite? Message me.
- 4 **Open cs50.dev** and sign in with your GitHub account — that's where you'll write your code.
- 5 Start **Module 1**: Lab 0, Problem Set 0, Collaborative 0.

Week one is the heaviest — on purpose. Nearly all of it is one-time setup.

The rules that actually matter

Deadlines. Weekly work is due Sunday 11:59 PM Pacific and stays open three more days, to Wed 11:59 PM, at full credit — no penalty, no permission needed. Canvas will stamp it “late.” Ignore the label. First-week assignments, in-class work, and the final project are outside that window.

AI. The CS50 Duck, built into cs50.dev, is always allowed on take-home work. No other AI may write, complete, or suggest code you submit unless an assignment says otherwise; using one to explain a concept or an error message is fine — cite it in a comment. The standard: you must be able to explain why it works and change it on request, unaided. You'll code in **cs50.dev**, which has AI autocomplete already turned off.

In-class, on paper. A short quiz most Mondays — eight in all, lowest dropped, and that drop is the make-up — plus the midterm **Wed, Oct 28**, and the final exam **Mon, Nov 30**. None has a three-day window. Need DAC testing? Set up both exams in week one; book Nov 30 by **Fri, Nov 20**.

Participation is 25% — graded on effort, not correctness. Show your reasoning and a wrong answer still earns full credit.

Attendance. Come to both sessions. Miss one? Message me on Slack and I'll give you an equivalent for the in-class work.

Where to get help

Stuck on the material → Slack me, or come to student hours (Zoom link in Canvas)

Stuck on your code → explain it to your rubber duck, then the CS50 Duck, then Slack

Tutoring, tech help, accommodations, food and housing, college policies → Syllabus Information 26–27 in Canvas

Need a computer → open computer labs, or borrow a laptop through Clark ITS

Need coffee → Keurig in my office, SHL 127, off our classroom — mugs, cream, and sugar too

Your grade

Discussion, participation & collaboration	25%
Problem sets	20%
Final project	20%
Midterm	10%
Quizzes (weekly, in class)	10%
Final exam	10%
Labs	5%

GRADE	A	B	C	D
Range	94+	84–86	70–76	60–69

Full scale is in the syllabus. A grade of **C or better** is required for this course to count toward a degree or certificate.

Dates to write down

Sept 21	First day of class
Week 5	Final project assigned
Oct 19–23	
Oct 28	Midterm — in class, on paper
Nov 11	No class — Veterans Day
Nov 25	No class — Thanksgiving
Nov 30	Final exam — in class, on paper
Dec 3	Last day to withdraw
Dec 4	Final project due 11:59 PM — firm
Dec 7–10	Finals week — project presentations

Weeks 8 and 10 have only **one** class session, and the final exam is the Monday right after Thanksgiving break. Review in Week 9, not over the holiday.

If things go sideways

Illness, work, family, a genuinely brutal week — **message me before the deadline** and we'll set a new date. I grant these. I just need to hear from you.

Almost every problem is solvable in Week 3 and much harder to solve in Week 10.